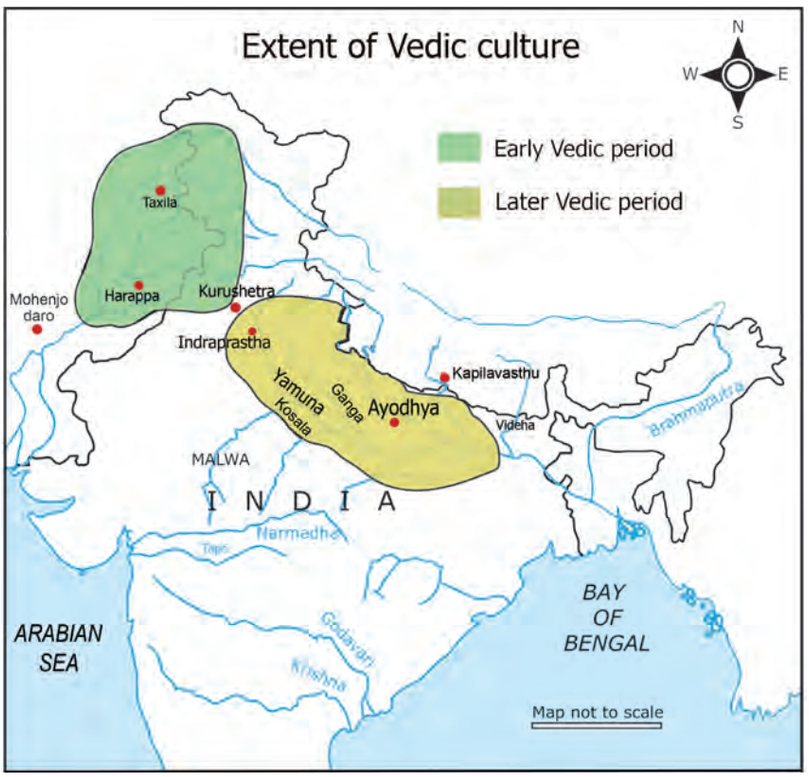



| Time, Spread and Sources | |
|---|---|
| Geographical range | North India |
| Period | Iron Age |
| Time | 1500 BC (BCE) – 600 BC (BCE) |
| Sources | Vedic Literature |
| Nature of Civilisation | Rural |

## Aryans and their Home in India

- Aryans of the Rig Vedic Period were semi-nomadic. They were basically pastoral people with cattle as their main source of wealth.
- In the Rig Vedic times, the Aryan homeland was the Punjab, which was at that time called Sapta Sindhu, the land of seven rivers.
- Around 1000 BC (BCE), Aryans in India moved eastward and settled in Indo-Gangetic Plain.
- Use of iron axes and ploughs became widespread.

**DO YOU KNOW?**

**Four Vedas**

1. Rig
2. Yajur
3. Sama
4. Atharva

## Sources

### Vedic literature

Vedic literature can be classified into two broad categories.

1. **Shrutis -** The Shrutis comprise the four Vedas, the Brahmanas, the Aranyakas and the Upanishads. They are considered sacred, eternal, and an unquestionable truth.

   'Shruti' means listening (or unwritten) ones that were transmitted orally through generations.

2. **Smritis -** A body of texts containing teachings on religion such as